

Free Windows

Microsoft will give away free copies of Windows 7 to chosen people in the US, during the launch parties between October 22-29

A phone with XPerience

The xPhone is a fully-featured, sliding QWERTY cellphone with Windows XP as its operating system!

DIY



Making Windows XP look and feel like Windows 7

Want to enjoy the most talked about features of Windows 7, but don't want to shift from good old Windows XP? It's time to get the best of both worlds, in only 30 minutes flat!

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Even though many XP users are still reluctant to make the switch to Windows 7, several new features and innovative UI modifications make it nearly impossible to resist. For all those who still don't want to leave their good old XP (and don't want to install all their applications all over again) there are plenty of 3rd party software to get the best features of Windows 7 in Windows XP. In fact, it won't take more than 30 minutes to get most of them up & running on your XP machine!

Before you get started, create a system restore point, just in case some application starts acting a little funny. For this, go to **Start > All Programs > Accessories > System Tools > System Restore** to create one.

[00.00] Adding the superbar

The Superbar minimises the space taken by each application instance by only displaying the icon of the application and grouping similar instances of an application as one. You can click on the icon to choose the instances you want to open (Just



The new & improved Superbar in Windows 7 (Left), Superbar (with options) in XP using ViGlance

click on the thumbnail to open it).

ViGlance doesn't require an installation. Just run the software (And choose between a few options) and you're done. Right click on any of the notification icons. Check options to select animations and other effects. You can also drag and drop the icons, just like you can in Windows 7. Also, similar to Superbar, you can pin items that might be open so that their link stays on the taskbar, even when they aren't open. Though ViGlance at times doesn't load the thumbnails quickly, it surely de-clutters your taskbar and gives you a much more fun UI!

If you're looking for more flexibility or eye candy, try out any dock software such as RocketDock from <http://rocketdock.com/download>.

[05.00] Adding Task switching Keys

Another feature of the "Superbar" is that it allows you to use combinations such as Windows + [1] to open the first menu on the taskbar and so on. It cycles through all open instances of the particular application if it's already open otherwise starts the application. To get this functionality, just download ActivateByNum and run it. It's a small Autohotkey script (If you use other Autohotkeys, you can just add the script as well).

Caution: One of the problems with running both ActivateByNum and ViGlance together is that ViGlance doesn't change the order of the taskbar items, which means that you must not drag the taskbar items or else ActivateByNum will not be able

to number the applications correctly.

[10.00] Splitting Windows and AeroPeek

With Windows 7 comes a new set of shortcuts to arrange your open windows. You can "snap" open windows to different edges of your screen, which is helpful if you quickly want to divide the screen into two separate halves. This is done with the Windows + Left or Right keys. Pressing Windows + Space bar on the other hand, displays the desktop by making all applications transparent. There are several applications that allow you to get the same functionality in Windows XP, but we'll just look at Windows Split. With its range of options the application is a delight for any power user. Install the software and check the list of Shortcuts available. Also, it allows you to customise each split (Layout Settings) so you can enjoy as much flexibility as you want to. Download this nifty app from <http://www.winsplit-revolution.com/download>

[15.00] Shaking off all inactive windows using AeroShake

Another UI improvement that was seen in Windows 7 is the

SUPERBAR USING VIGLANCE

- Add more functionality to your Taskbar!
Link: <http://www.lee-soft.com/vigance/>
- Another alternative is to go for Windows 7 Superbar by Haran-Hockey. This uses themes to change the behaviour of the Windows Taskbar.
[Windows 7 Superbar: <http://haran-hockey.deviantart.com/art/Windows-7-Superbar-for-XP-104697395>]
- Taskbaric is another small tool that allows you to show open windows as icons on your taskbar, though it lacks other features of Superbar
[Taskbaric: <http://sites.google.com/site/taskbaric/>]

FOR KEYBOARD WARRIORS

Keyboard switching through the taskbar with ActivateByNum

Description: Run ActivateByNum to switch to different application/application instances by using the [Win+num] combination
Link: <http://code.google.com/p/activatebynum/>

Adding customizable Keyboard Shortcuts

Description: Use Autohotkey to write powerful scripts to do nearly anything with your Windows, with just a few key press!
Link: <http://www.autohotkey.com/download/>